

tell the sonographer at the start of the scan.

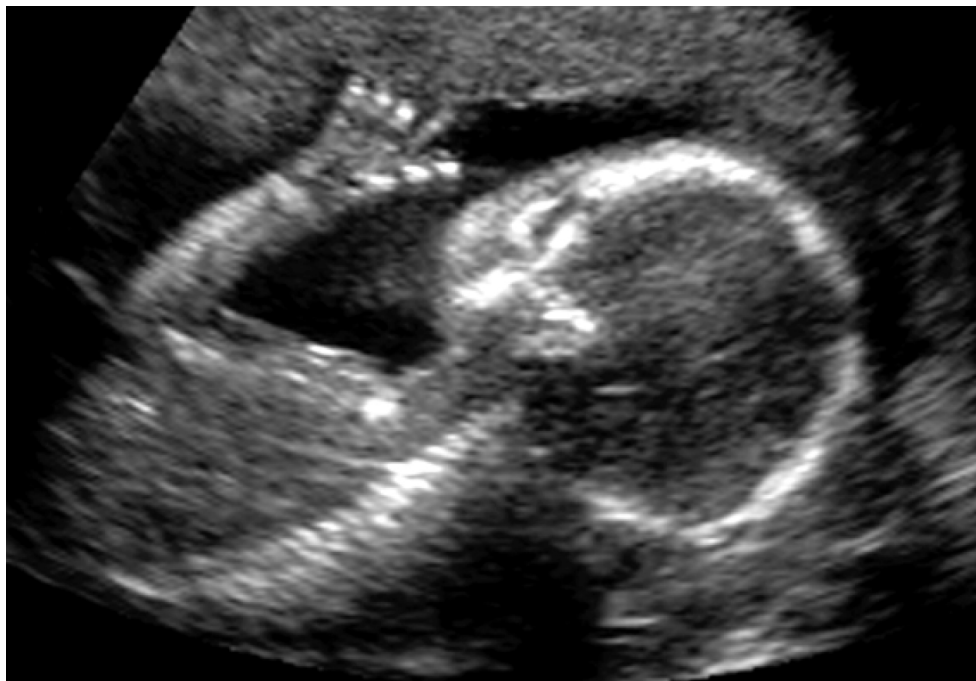
THE ULTRASOUND

The baby's organs are examined in detail and therefore it can take a little longer than previous scans. If the result of your [PAPP-A](#) test was low, or you have other risk factors for preeclampsia, you may also be offered a Doppler scan to look at the blood flow in the uterine arteries. The scan checks:

- **The brain**, including the fluid-filled spaces inside the brain and the shape of the back of your baby's brain (cerebellum).
- **The spine** for spina bifida or other spinal problems.
- **The upper lip** for [cleft lip](#).
- **The heart**, and the heartbeat, to rule out any major heart malformation.
- **The stomach** and diaphragm.
- **The kidneys and bladder**, making sure that both kidneys are present and there are no blockages or malformations.
- **The abdominal wall**, to look for a defect, known as gastroschisis.
- **Your baby's limbs**, to make sure there are no hand or feet malformations, such as club foot.
- **The umbilical cord**, to check that this has a normal number of blood vessels.

HOW THE SCAN IS INTERPRETED

During your ultrasound, a picture of your baby is produced when high-frequency sound waves bounce off your baby's organs and tissues and translate into an image on-screen. In this image, solid matter, such as bones, are white, while softer tissue appears gray. Areas that contain fluid, such as blood vessels or the stomach, as well as the amniotic fluid, do not respond to the sound waves and therefore appear as black areas on the scan. The sonographer will study these details to assess how your baby is developing in the uterus.



The skull is well developed by now, and features such as the ears are clearly seen.